crowd of 33 000 seems excited as Umesh Yadav gets ready to bowl the last over of the innings. Farhaan is striking the ball beautifully, and he hits the first three deliveries for four, four and six before pushing the fourth ball into the covers and calling for a single.

The Indian crowd roars. Why are they so excited about a single? Or are they just pleased to concede one run? It soon becomes clear that, in fact, they are making this noise because they want me on strike so I can reach my century.

'A-B-D! A-B-D! A-B-D!'

A shiver runs down my spine. It really does. I can't believe this is happening. To hear people chant my initials when I am playing for Royal Challengers Bangalore is one thing, but to hear so many supporters chanting for me when I am batting for South Africa, the opposition, against India, their heroes, is something else.

'A-B-D! A-B-D! A-B-D!'

Yadav runs in to bowl. I swing ... hard, across the line ... and miss. The spectators groan. My score stays 98 not out, and there is now just one ball remaining in the innings.

'A-B-D! A-B-D! A-B-D!'

Here comes Yadav again. As usual, I concentrate on keeping my head perfectly still, trying to judge the length in a split second. Yadav bowls ... I swing and connect, flat-batted ... and the ball soars towards long-on, and over the head of long-on, and into the crowd for six ... and the noise in the stadium gets even louder ...

We finished on 303 for five in 50 overs, but the match was far from won. Rohit Sharma played another fantastic innings and led what looked like a comfortable chase, until they required only 35 runs from the last four overs. Then Imran Tahir turned the match in the 47th over, beating Rohit with his leg break and clasping a return catch, and using his googly to deceive Suresh Raina and have him caught at long-on.